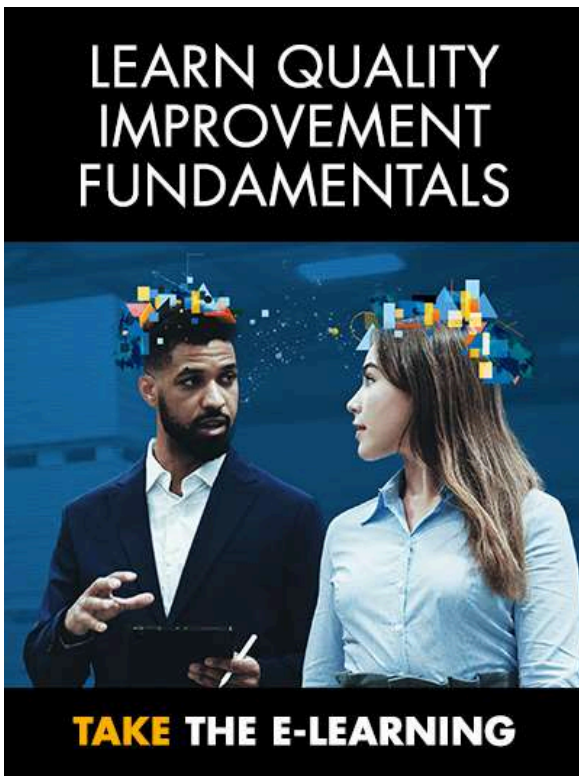


QUALITY ASSURANCE VS QUALITY CONTROL: QA VS QC



Overview

Two terms that have many interpretations because of the multiple definitions for the words “assurance” and “control.” For example, “assurance” can mean the act of giving confidence, the state of being certain or the act of making certain; “control” can mean an evaluation to indicate needed corrective responses, the act of guiding or the state of a process in which the variability is attributable to a constant system of chance causes. One definition of quality assurance is: all the planned and systematic activities implemented within the quality system that can be demonstrated to provide confidence that a product or service will fulfill requirements for quality. One definition for quality control is: the operational techniques and activities used to fulfill requirements for quality. Often, however, “quality assurance” and “quality control” are used interchangeably, referring to the actions performed to ensure the quality of a product, service or process.



DIFFERENCES BETWEEN QA AND QC

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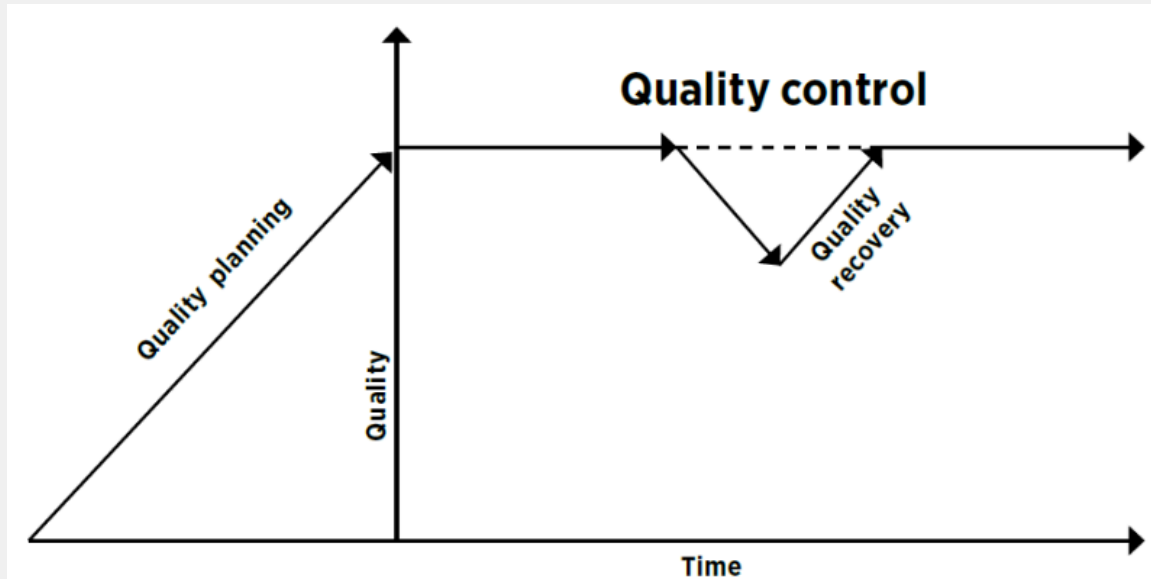
Quality assurance and quality control are two aspects of quality management. While some quality assurance and quality control activities are interrelated, the two are defined differently. Typically, QA activities and responsibilities cover virtually all of the quality system in one fashion or another, while QC is a subset of the QA activities. Also, elements in the quality system might not be specifically covered by QA/QC activities and responsibilities but may involve QA and QC.

Quality Assurance

Quality assurance can be defined as "part of *quality management* focused on providing confidence that *quality requirements* will be fulfilled." The confidence provided by quality assurance is twofold—internally to management and externally to customers, government agencies, regulators, certifiers, and third parties. An alternate definition is "all the planned and systematic activities implemented within the quality system that can be demonstrated to provide confidence that a product or service will fulfill requirements for quality."

Quality Control

Quality control can be defined as "part of *quality management* focused on fulfilling *quality requirements*." While quality assurance relates to how a process is performed or how a product is made, quality control is more the inspection aspect of quality management. An alternate definition is "the operational techniques and activities used to fulfill requirements for quality."



INDUSTRY PERSPECTIVES ON QA AND QC

HISTORY OF QA AND QC

COMMUNITY

CERTIFICATIONS

Community

myASQ's online communities provide expanded networking and learning opportunities, including blog posts, discussion threads, and library entries on topics like the fishbone diagram. Members can create new communities to generate new discussions and connections, and anyone can join online communities to reach a broader audience of quality professionals and practitioners – anytime, anywhere.